



Sure Access to Success

DIRECT – INDIRECT RULES

Prof. Tommy Cherian
8547006780



Direct Speech

- **When the exact words of the speaker are quoted.**
- *Structure:*
- [Speaker] + says/said + “exact words”
- *Example:*
- He said, “I am going to the market.”

Indirect (Reported) Speech

- Used when the words of the speaker are reported without quoting exactly, often changing pronouns, tenses, and words like "this" or "now".
- *Structure:*
- [Speaker] + said/told + that + reported sentence
- *Example:*
- He said that he was going to the market.

Basic Rules for Changing Direct to Indirect Speech

- Step 1: Remove quotation marks
- Step 2: Change pronouns appropriately
- Step 3: Change tenses (*in most cases*)
- Step 4: Change time/place words
- Step 5: Use "that" for statements, "if/whether" for yes-no questions, and question words for wh-questions

John said, “I am going to the market now.”
John said that he was going to the market then.

- **Step 1: Remove quotation marks**

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- **Step 2: Change pronouns appropriately**

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- **Step 4: Change time/place words**

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- Step 4: Change time/place words
- **Step 5: Use "that" for statements, "if/whether" for yes-no questions, and question words for wh-questions**

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

• DIRECT SPEECH	INDIRECT SPEECH
• Present Simple →	Past Simple
• Present Continuous →	Past Continuous
• Present Perfect →	Past Perfect
• Past Simple →	Past Perfect
• Past Continuous →	Past Perfect Continuous
• Will/shall →	Would/should
• Can/may →	Could/might

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Present Simple →

He said, "I **play** football." →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Simple

He said that he **played** football.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Present Continuous →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Continuous

She said, “I **am reading** a book.” → She said that she **was reading** a book.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Present Perfect →

They said, "We **have left**." →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Perfect

They said that they **had left**.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Past Simple →

He said, "I **went** to Delhi." →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Perfect

He said that he **had gone** to Delhi.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Past Continuous →

- He said, 'I **have been consulting** them.' → He said that he **had been consulting** them.

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Perfect Continuous

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Will/shall →

She said, “I **will help** you.” →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Would/should

She said that she **would help** me.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Can/may →

He said, "I **can** help her." →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Could/might

He said that he **could** help her.

Tense Change Rules

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Changes of Time Words

• DIRECT SPEECH

- Now
- Today
- Tomorrow
- Yesterday
- Ago

INDIRECT SPEECH

Then

That day

The next day / The following day

The previous day / The day before

Before

Changes of Time Words

• DIRECT SPEECH

- Now
- Today
- Tomorrow
- Yesterday
- Ago

INDIRECT SPEECH

Then
That day
The next day / The following day
The previous day / The day before
Before

He said, “I will call you **tomorrow**.”

→ He said that he would call me the **next day**.

She said, “I met him **yesterday**.”

→ She said that she had met him **the day before**.

Changes of Place Words

- **DIRECT SPEECH**

- This
- These
- Here

- **INDIRECT SPEECH**

That
Those
There

Changes of Place Words

• DIRECT SPEECH

- This
- These
- Here

INDIRECT SPEECH

That
Those
There

They said, “We are **here now**.”

→ They said that they were **there then**.

John said, ‘I don’t want **this** pen instead of **these** pencils.’

→ John said that he did not want **that** pen instead of **those** pencils.

How to Change Questions

Yes/No Questions (starting with Auxiliaries)

Use **if** or **whether**

He said, “Are you coming?” → He asked **if** I was coming.

How to Change Questions

Wh-Questions

Keep the question word, change structure to statement form.

She asked, “**Where** do you live?”

→ She asked **where** I lived.

How to Change Questions

Examples

He asked, "Do you like pizza?"

He asked if I liked pizza.

She asked, "Where are you going?"

She asked where I was going.

They said, "Is it raining?"

They asked if it was raining.

How to Change Questions

Examples

They **said**, “Is it raining?”

They **asked** if it was raining.

How to Change Commands, Requests, and Exclamations

Commands/Orders

Use told or ordered + to-infinitive

He said, "Sit down."

He told me to sit down.

How to Change Commands, Requests, and Exclamations

Negative Commands

Use not + to-infinitive

He said, “Don’t go there.”

He told me not to go there.

How to Change Commands, Requests, and Exclamations

Exclamations

Express with words like exclaimed, wished, prayed, etc.

She said, “**Wow!** What a beautiful house!”

She **exclaimed** that it was a beautiful house.

Exceptions Where Tense Does Not Change

1. If the reporting verb is in present/future tense
2. If the reported speech expresses a universal truth or fact

Exceptions Where Tense Does Not Change

- If the reporting verb is in present/future tense

He **says**, "I like coffee." →

He **says** that he likes coffee.

Exceptions Where Tense Does Not Change

- If the reported speech expresses a universal truth or fact.

The teacher said, “The sun **rises** in the east.”

The teacher said that the sun **rises** in the east.

How to Change Indirect Speech to Direct Speech?

Reverse the process:

- Remove "that," "if," or "whether"
- Restore the original tense
- Change pronouns back to original form
- Replace time/place words accordingly
- Add quotation marks

How to Change Indirect Speech to Direct Speech?

Reverse the process:

- Remove "that," "if," or "whether"
- Restore the original tense
- Change pronouns back to original form
- Replace time/place words accordingly
- Add quotation marks
- **Indirect: He said that he was hungry.**
- **Direct: He said, "I am hungry."**
- **Indirect: She asked if I was busy.**
- **Direct: She asked, "Are you busy?"**
- **Indirect: They said that they would come the next day.**
- **Direct: They said, "We will come tomorrow."**

Summary

• TYPE	DIRECT SPEECH EXAMPLE	INDIRECT SPEECH EXAMPLE
• Statement	He said, "I am tired."	He said that he was tired.
• Yes/No Qs	She asked, "Are you okay?"	She asked if I was okay.
• Wh-Question	He asked, "Where is she?"	He asked where she was.
• Command	She said, "Close the door."	She told me to close the door.
• - Ve Command	He said, "Don't shout."	He told me not to shout.
• Request	She said, "Please help me."	She requested me to help her.
• Exclamation	He said, "What a day!"	He exclaimed that it was a terrible day.

Quick Tips

- Always check the tense of the reporting verb first.
- Pronouns change based on speaker and listener.
- Time/place words change based on context.
- Structure of questions changes to statements in reported speech.
- Don't change tense for universal truths